

Trading Bot — Session Summary for Developer Review

Dates covered: June 29–30, 2026 **Prepared by:** Joshua Berman (with Claude assistance during live troubleshooting)

TL;DR

Over two sessions I made a number of live, hand-applied edits directly to the codebase on my Mac (not through GitHub) while testing the bot in Alpaca paper trading. The bot did place and manage one real paper trade successfully end-to-end. However, the code has since been patched repeatedly via ad-hoc terminal commands, hit multiple crashes, and at one point the paper account showed a -15.17% swing (\$15,098 unrealized) that I don't fully understand the cause of. **Please review the files listed below against the original repo before this runs unattended again**, even in paper mode.

Files Modified Locally (Not Yet Pushed)

- `src/ai_analyzer.py`
- `src/config.py`
- `src/executor.py`
- `src/market_data.py` (attempted fix, may need re-review)
- `.env` (new variables added, see below)
- New file: `~/trading-bot/autorun.sh` (restart-on-crash wrapper, not part of original repo)
- New file: `~/trading-bot/scan.py` (60-second loop wrapper, not part of original repo)

Summary of Changes Made

1. Switched AI provider from Claude/Anthropic to local Ollama (Mistral)

In `ai_analyzer.py`: replaced the `anthropic.Anthropic` client and `messages.create()` call with `ollama.chat()` using the local `mistral` model. Also made the system prompt more

aggressive/less conservative per my request, since the original prompt was rejecting nearly every candidate. **This prompt change has not been tuned carefully — please review the wording in `SYSTEM` before relying on it.**

2. Stop loss changed from 3% to 6%

In `config.py`, `STOP_PCT` default changed from `0.03` to `0.06`. Also added `STOP_PCT=0.06` to `.env`.

3. Max float filter fixed

The scanner was using `MAX_FLOAT = 20_000_000` (20M) when the intended strategy threshold is 2,000,000 (2M). Changed in `config.py` and added `MAX_FLOAT=2000000` to `.env`.

4. Added end-of-day forced close at 8:00 PM ET

In `executor.py`, the position management loop originally used a relative deadline (`time.time() + max_minutes * 60`), which meant the actual close time depended on when the trade was entered rather than a fixed clock time. I replaced this with a calculation based on a fixed 8:00 PM ET cutoff using `pytz`. **This section was edited several times due to repeated indentation errors and should be reviewed line-by-line — I do not have full confidence the logic is identical to what was intended.**

5. Added `ANTHROPIC_API_KEY=local` placeholder to `.env`

This was added as a workaround because `config.py` checks for the presence of this key to decide whether AI analysis is “enabled,” even though the AI calls no longer go to Anthropic. **This is a hack, not a real fix** — the config logic should probably be updated to check for Ollama availability instead of an Anthropic key.

Bugs Encountered

1. `StockHistoricalDataClient / ScreenerClient` **had no attribute `get_stock_snapshots`** — fixed by switching to the correct singular method name `get_stock_snapshot` after inspecting the installed Alpaca SDK directly.
2. **Multiple `IndentationError` crashes in `executor.py`**, recurring even after fixes — likely from compounding `sed/string-replace` edits on the same file across the session. Final state passes `ast.parse()` (syntax valid) as of this writing, but **logic has not been independently reviewed**.
3. **Recurring Alpaca WebSocket disconnects** (`no close frame received or sent`)

causing the price stream to silently drop and the bot to eventually crash with `ConnectionError` / `TimeoutError`. This needs proper reconnect/retry handling — currently `autorun.sh` just restarts the whole process after a crash, which is a blunt workaround.

4. **Daily trade counter does not reset when a position is manually closed in Alpaca.**

After manually closing MSTU, `state.py` still reported `Trades today: 1` and blocked the bot from evaluating new candidates the next day, even though the account was flat. Worth checking whether the daily counter should reset based on account state (no open positions) rather than purely a calendar day.

5. **No position-recovery on restart.** If the bot crashes or is restarted while holding an open position, it does not reconnect to monitor that position's stop loss / profit targets / EOD close. This is the most important gap to close before going live with real money — a crash mid-trade currently means the position is unmanaged until I notice manually.

Open Question — Unexplained -15.17% Portfolio Swing

On 6/30 around 1:42 PM ET, while MSTU was still an open position from the prior session (I had not yet closed it), the Alpaca paper account showed equity drop from ~\$99,500 to \$84,414.05, a ~\$15,098 unrealized loss. I closed all positions manually shortly after. I don't have a confirmed root cause — it could be a stale/leftover position interacting badly with a restarted bot instance, a data/pricing display issue, or something else. **Please investigate via the Alpaca activity/order history for that account before trusting any P&L numbers from this session.**

What Worked

- Local Mistral integration via Ollama is functional — confirmed the model received real prompts and returned structured JSON decisions with reasoning.
- The bot successfully scanned, selected a candidate (MSTU), got AI approval, sized the position, submitted a limit buy, and recorded the trade entry — full pipeline worked once.
- The “daily trade limit reached” safety check correctly blocked a second trade attempt today, which is good defensive behavior.
- A manual single-cycle test (`Orchestrator().run_once()`) run late on 6/30 completed cleanly with no crash and no syntax errors.

Recommended Next Steps

1. Pull this conversation's file list and diff each modified file against the GitHub version to see the exact changes line-by-line, rather than reconstructing from chat history.
2. Review and likely rewrite the EOD-close logic in `executor.py` cleanly rather than building on today's patches.
3. Fix the daily-trade-counter reset logic in `state.py`.
4. Add position recovery on bot startup (check Alpaca for open positions and resume monitoring).
5. Add proper WebSocket reconnect/retry handling instead of relying on full-process restarts.
6. Review and likely rewrite the `SYSTEM` prompt in `ai_analyzer.py` — it was changed quickly today to be "more aggressive" without careful tuning.
7. Investigate the unexplained equity swing before trusting paper trading results.
8. Update `requirements.txt` to include `ollama` and confirm whether `anthropic` is still a dependency or can be removed.